SENATOR ANGELA S. PAXTON
DISTRICT 8

June 18, 2026

Mr. Norman Roy Garza, Jr.
Executive Director, Texas Space Commission
125 East 11th Street
Austin, Texas 78701

RE: Exos Aerospace Space Exploration & Aeronautics Research Fund (SEARF) Direct Award

Dear Director Garza:

I write in support of Exos Aerospace Systems & Technologies, Inc. ("Exos"), a Greenville-based aerospace company in Hunt County and within Senate District 8.

Exos is one of only three companies in the United States currently licensed by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) to launch and recover a reusable rocket. They design, build, and test their vehicles in Greenville, Texas, supporting high-skill aerospace and defense jobs in the North Texas region.

Exos holds an active U.S. Air Force SBIR Phase II contract (FA9300-25-C-6022) to advance Rotating Detonation Rocket Engine (RDRE) technology and has submitted a Tactical Funding Increase (TACFI) proposal that has received a strong endorsement from the Air Force Research Laboratory. To meet TACFI's 1:1 non-SBIR matching requirement, Exos is requesting a $2,000,000 SEARF Direct Award under 10 TAC § 321.16. This state match would unlock up to $2,000,000 in federal TACFI funds for a $4,000,000 RDRE flight-test program to be performed entirely in Greenville, and could position Exos for substantial follow-on federal opportunities.

I respectfully ask that the Commission give full and timely consideration to Exos's SEARF Direct Award request, with awareness of the June 26, 2026 timeline associated with the federal TACFI program.

Thank you for your leadership of the Texas Space Commission and for your attention to this request.

Blessings,

Angela S. Paxton

Senator Angela Paxton

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